

All figures sourced from Government of Alberta open data, Statistics Canada, federal statute, UN treaty, and peer-reviewed research.

Building Up: A Blueprint for the Alberta Accessibility and Inclusion Act

Part Three — The Alberta Accessibility and Inclusion Act: A Constructive Blueprint

Section 3.6 — Amendment - Internal Community Complexity in the Consultation Framework

The substantive Section 3.6 consultation framework developed across the prior content of Section 3.6 establishes the substantive Article 4(3) operational standard, the substantive Indigenous-rights structural integration, the substantive Disability Community Advisory Council infrastructure, the substantive Standards Development Committees with substantive disability-community-representation requirements, and the substantive consultation-process provisions calibrated to operate substantively across the substantive scope, depth, timing, documentation, response, and remedy dimensions. The substantive Section 3.6 framework operates on the substantive operational premise that the substantive disability community is a substantive constituency that requires substantive operational engagement through the substantive consultation infrastructure.

The substantive Section 3.6 amendment addresses a substantive operational complication that the substantive consultation framework must engage directly: the substantive disability community is not a unified substantive constituency. The substantive operational reality is that the substantive disability community operates within substantive internal complexities and substantive operational tensions that affect substantive policy advocacy and that the substantive consultation framework must address operationally rather than treat as resolved. The substantive amendment establishes the substantive operational principles that operate alongside the substantive Section 3.6 consultation framework to address the substantive internal-community complexity at the operational depth the substantive consultation infrastructure requires.

The Substantive Internal-Community Complexity

The substantive operational reality of the disability community in Alberta and across Canada includes substantive internal-community complexity operating across multiple substantive dimensions:

Substantive framework tensions. The substantive disability community operates across multiple substantive policy frameworks that operate in substantive operational tension on substantive issues. The substantive disability-rights framework (oriented toward independent living, community-based supports, anti-institutional positions, social-model disability framing, cross-disability positions, lived-experience-leadership) operates within substantive operational tensions with the substantive disability-services-organization framework (which sometimes operates institutional or partial-institutional services, sometimes operates within medical-model framing, sometimes operates substantive professional-service-provision authority over substantive disability-community engagement). The substantive operational implication is that the substantive consultation framework must operate substantively across both substantive frameworks while substantively privileging the substantive

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disability-rights framework operating from substantive lived-experience-leadership in accordance with the substantive Article 4(3) "close consultation with and active involvement of persons with disabilities, including children with disabilities, through their representative organizations" framework.

Substantive constituency tensions. The substantive disability community operates across substantive constituency lines that operate within substantive operational tensions on substantive issues. The substantive cross-disability constituency (operating across all disability profiles and oriented toward common substantive policy positions across the disability community as a whole) operates within substantive operational tensions with the substantive disability-specific constituencies (deaf community, autistic community, learning-disability community, mental-health-disability community, physical-disability community, intellectual-disability community, chronic-illness community, and others) that operate substantively distinct policy positions on substantive issues affecting their substantive populations specifically. The substantive operational implication is that the substantive consultation framework must operate substantively across both substantive cross-disability and substantive disability-specific constituency engagement, with substantive operational provisions for the substantive disability-specific consultation engagement on substantive issues affecting specific substantive populations.

Substantive voice tensions. The substantive disability community operates across substantive voice categories that operate within substantive operational tensions on substantive issues. The substantive adult-with-lived-experience voice (operating from substantive direct experience of the substantive disability profile) operates within substantive operational tensions with the substantive parent-of-child-with-disability voice (operating from substantive caregiver-perspective engagement with the substantive disability profile) on substantive issues including substantive inclusive education, substantive supported decision-making, substantive autonomy-and-protection balance, substantive medical-and-clinical engagement frameworks, and substantive intervention-and-therapy frameworks. The substantive operational implication is that the substantive consultation framework must operate substantively across both substantive voice categories with substantive operational provisions for the substantive distinct engagement of each, while substantively privileging the substantive adult-with-lived-experience voice on substantive issues affecting the substantive autonomy-and-self-determination of the population the policy serves directly.

Substantive linguistic-and-cultural complexity. The substantive disability community operates within substantive linguistic-and-cultural complexity that the substantive consultation framework must engage operationally. The substantive operational implications include: substantive English-language and French-language advocacy infrastructure operating substantively distinctly within the substantive Alberta francophone community; substantive cultural-and-religious-diversity dimensions operating substantively distinctly across the substantive newcomer-and-immigrant Albertan disability community (the substantive intersectional dimension developed in the substantive separate Intersectional Disability in Alberta evidentiary record); substantive Indigenous-disability-community substantive linguistic-and-cultural complexity operating within the substantive Treaty 6, Treaty 7, and Treaty 8 territories and within the substantive Métis Settlements framework as documented in Section 3.6 substantive Indigenous-rights provisions; and substantive 2SLGBTQ+ and gender-diverse substantive complexity operating across the substantive intersection with disability.

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Substantive medical-model and disability-rights-framing tensions. The substantive operational reality is that substantive medical-model framing continues to operate substantively across substantive provincial-government, healthcare-system, professional-services-provider, and substantive media-and-advocacy contexts even where the substantive disability-rights framework is the substantive policy direction the substantive international human rights framework requires. The substantive operational implication is that substantive consultation engagement may operate within substantive medical-model framing within substantive professional-service-provider and substantive medical-clinical contexts even where the substantive disability-rights framework operates within substantive disability-community lived-experience contexts. The substantive consultation framework must operate substantively across both substantive framings while substantively privileging the substantive disability-rights framework as the substantive operational standard the substantive international human rights framework requires.

The Substantive Operational Implications

The substantive operational implications for the substantive consultation framework include the following substantive principles:

Multiple substantive tables. The substantive consultation framework operates through multiple substantive operational tables rather than through a single substantive table. The substantive Section 3.6 operational infrastructure (the Disability Community Advisory Council, the Indigenous-Disability-Community Consultation Council, the Disability Community Education Consultation Council established in Section 3.4) operates substantively as multiple substantive tables; the substantive amendment establishes the substantive operational principle that additional substantive disability-specific consultation infrastructure can be operationalized as substantive operational requirements identify substantive distinct constituencies whose substantive operational engagement requires substantive distinct infrastructure.

Substantive distinct engagement of adult-with-lived-experience voices. The substantive consultation framework operates with substantive distinct provisions for substantive adult-with-lived-experience consultation engagement on substantive issues affecting substantive autonomy-and-self-determination of the population the policy serves directly. The substantive operational implication is that the substantive consultation infrastructure must include substantive infrastructure operationalized to engage substantive adult-with-lived-experience voices distinctly from substantive parent-and-family-advocacy voices on substantive issues including (but not limited to) substantive inclusive-education provisions, substantive supported-decision-making provisions, substantive autonomy-and-protection-balance provisions, substantive medical-and-clinical-engagement provisions, and substantive intervention-and-therapy-framework provisions.

Substantive avoiding default-to-largest-organization patterns. The substantive consultation framework operates substantively against the substantive default-to-largest-organization pattern in which substantive provincial-government consultation engagement defaults to the substantive disability-services-organization with the largest substantive operational scale or the substantive media-and-political profile, treating the substantive engagement with the largest organization as

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substantive sufficient consultation across the substantive disability community. The substantive operational principle is that the substantive consultation engagement must operate substantively across the substantive constituencies, frameworks, and voice categories rather than defaulting to substantive engagement with the substantive subset of the disability community whose substantive organizational scale or substantive media-and-political profile is most substantively visible to the substantive provincial-government infrastructure.

Substantive privileging of substantive disability-rights-framework operationalization. The substantive consultation framework operates substantively privileging the substantive disability-rights framework over the substantive medical-model framework where substantive operational tensions arise. The substantive operational principle is grounded in the substantive international human rights framework, the substantive *Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities* substantive interpretive infrastructure, and the substantive Charter Section 15 substantive-equality framework. The substantive operational implication is that the substantive consultation engagement that operates within substantive disability-rights framing receives substantive privileged operational weight in the substantive policy-development process.

Substantive transparency about consultation-input integration. The substantive consultation framework operates with substantive transparency provisions regarding the substantive integration of consultation input into the substantive policy-development process. The substantive operational implication is that the substantive consultation framework must operationalize substantive provisions establishing substantive public-documentation of which substantive consultation positions were operationalized into substantive policy provisions, which were not, and the substantive operational rationale for the substantive integration-and-non-integration decisions. The substantive operational principle is that the substantive consultation infrastructure operates as substantive accountability infrastructure rather than as substantive procedural-engagement infrastructure operating without substantive operational consequences.

What the Section 3.6 Amendment Establishes

The substantive Section 3.6 amendment establishes that the substantive consultation framework operates substantively across the substantive internal-community complexity at the operational depth the substantive disability-community operational reality requires. The substantive amendment is not a substantive replacement of the substantive Section 3.6 consultation framework; it is a substantive operational refinement that operates alongside the substantive Section 3.6 substantive provisions to address the substantive internal-community complexity at the operational level the substantive operational reality requires.

The substantive amendment operates substantively in coordination with the broader substantive Section 3.6 framework including the substantive Article 4(3) operational standard, the substantive Indigenous-rights structural integration, and the substantive consultation-process provisions across the substantive scope, depth, timing, documentation, response, and remedy dimensions. The substantive amendment establishes the substantive operational principle that the substantive consultation framework operates substantively across the substantive disability-community internal complexity while substantively

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privileging the substantive disability-rights framework, the substantive cross-disability and disability-specific operational engagement, the substantive adult-with-lived-experience voices on substantive autonomy-and-self-determination issues, and the substantive transparency-and-accountability operational infrastructure that the substantive consultation framework requires.

The substantive standalone document *Inside the Consultation Process* is queued as substantive separate workstream (per the substantive blueprint extension recommendations) to operationalize the substantive amendment provisions at substantive operational depth across the substantive operational reality of substantive consultation engagement. The substantive document will operate as substantive complementary infrastructure to the substantive Section 3.6 amendment within the substantive blueprint.